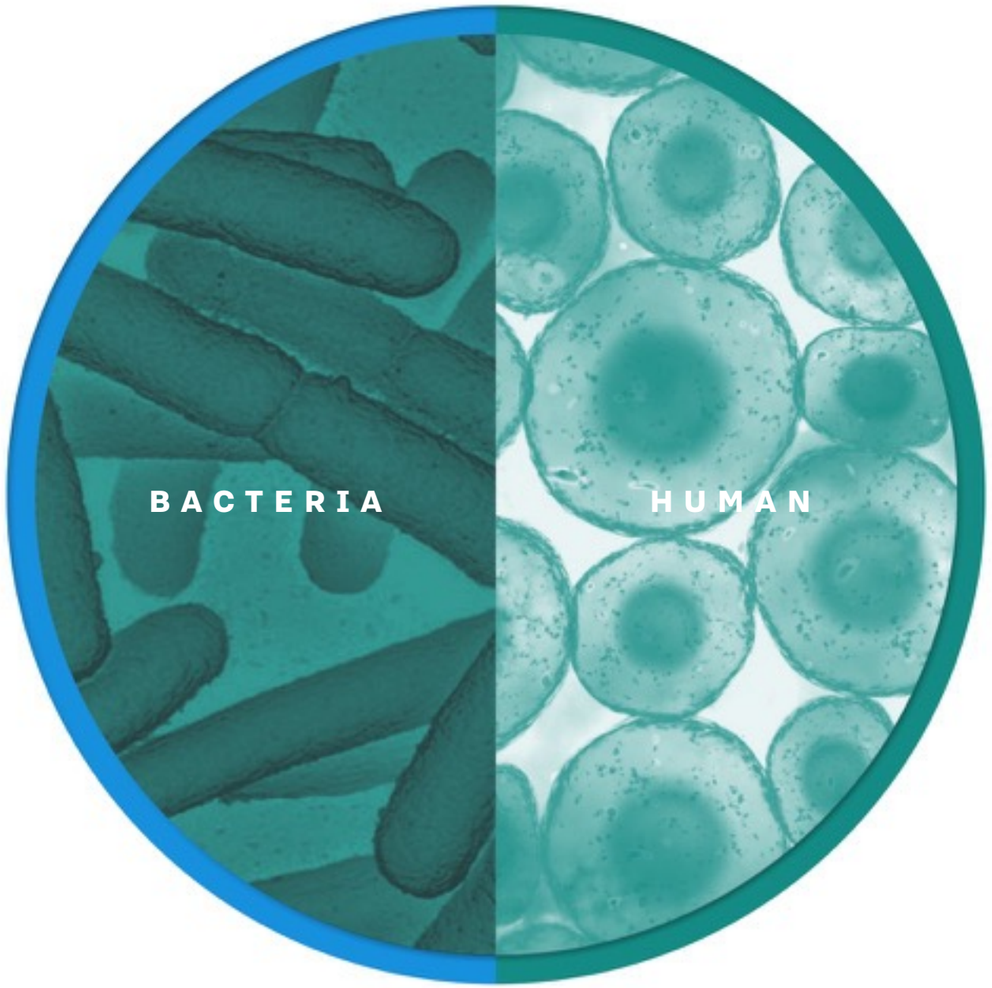
Did you know you're only half human?

50% of you is actually bacteria.

This ecosystem inside us is called the microbiome and it's one of the most important breakthroughs since the sequencing of the human genome.



The microbiome is a big deal.

Like, a really big f*cking deal.

And this is just the beginning...

Microbiome Companies Attract Big Investments

EDUCATE / SEPT 18 2016

The "Friendly" Bacteria In Your Gut...

SCIENCE / APR 28 2016

Altering gut microbes... could prevent asthma and allergies

HEALTH / SEPT 12 2016

Microbes maketh man

COVER STORY / AUG 18 2012

In good health? Thank your 100 Trillion Bacteria

HEALTH / JUNE 13 2012

The White House Launches the National Microbiome Initiative

SCIENCE / MAY 13 2016

Making Peace with Bacteria — for Good Health

THE BLOG / JUN 03 2016

The human microbiome: guts and glory

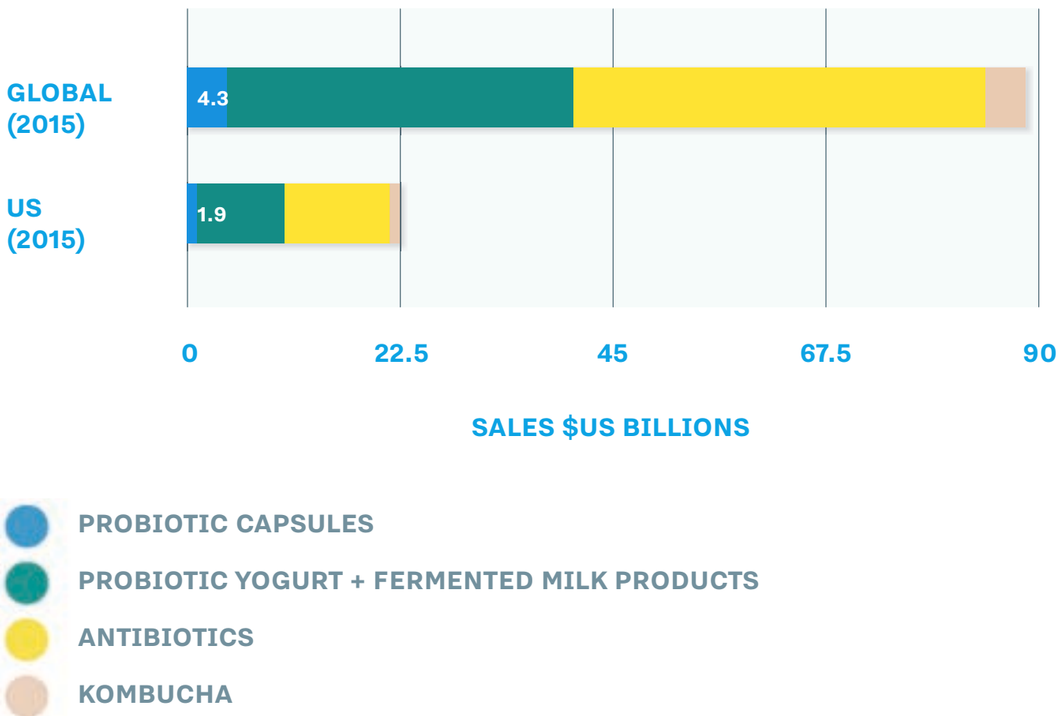
SPECIAL SERIES

The microbiome has profound implications for our health - as research progresses, we will tap into categories where this consumer is already spending

Here's how consumers are spending on the microbiome

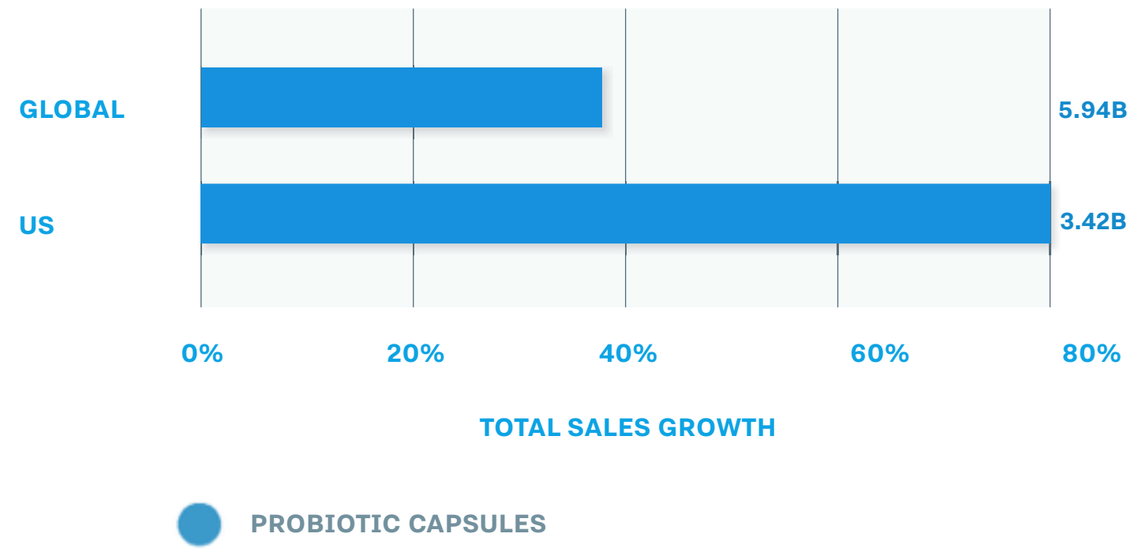
Total Achievable Market

Products positioned around probiotic benefit + antibiotics



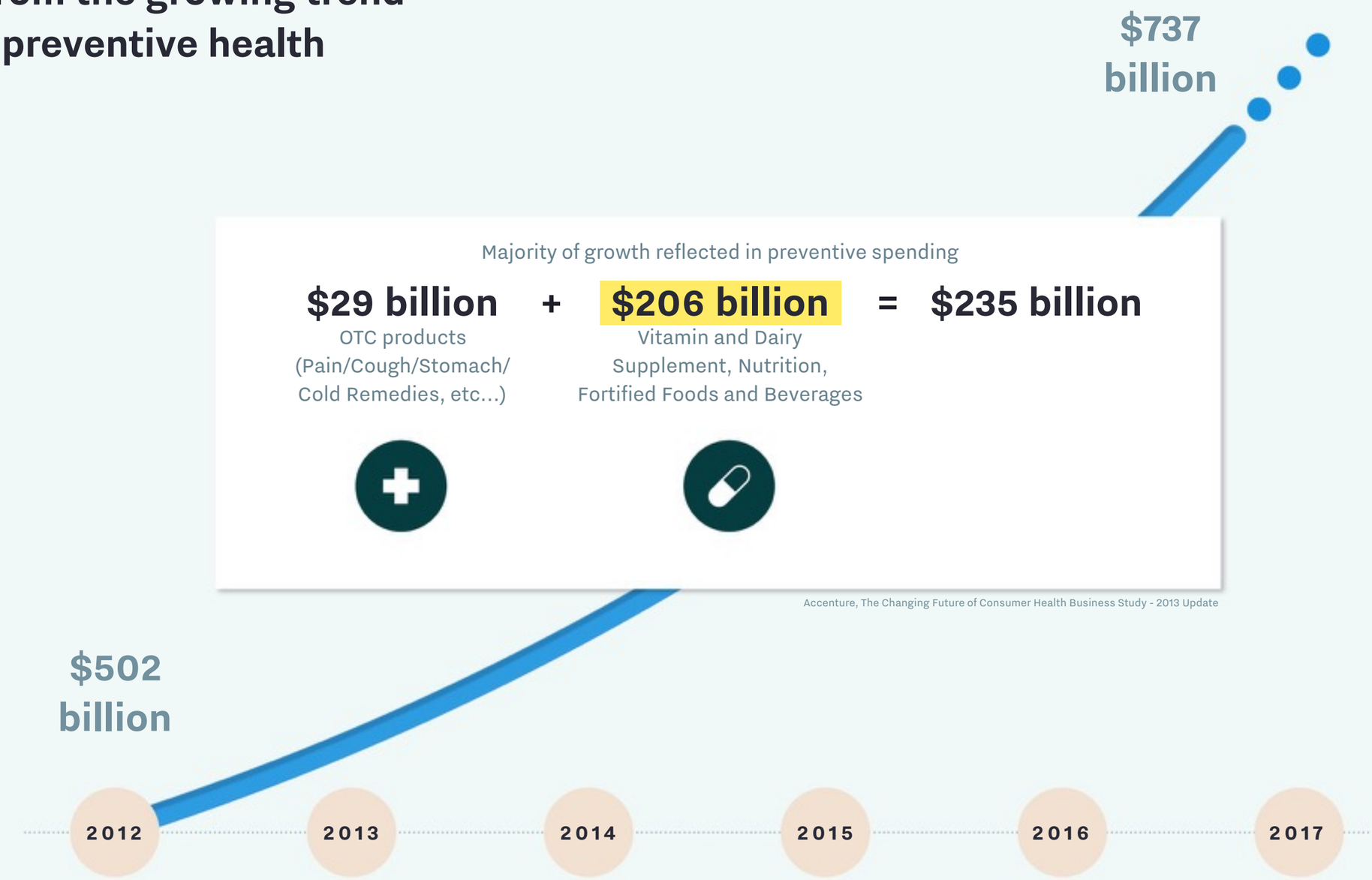
Projected Growth by 2020

Probiotic capsules will be the #1 fastest growing supplement by 2021

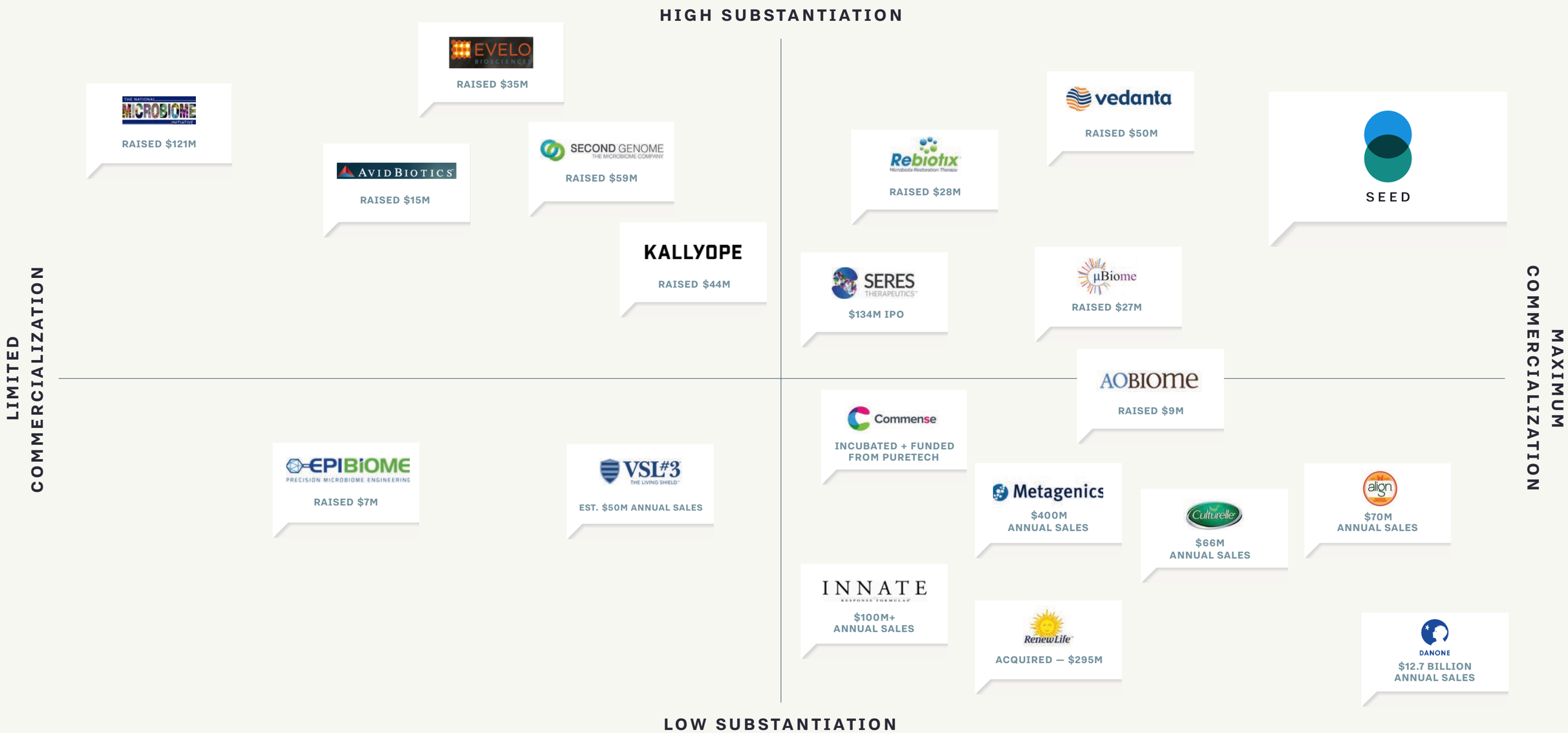


Euromonitor@SupplySideWest, Probiotic Supplements Will Be the #1 Fastest-Growing Supplement in North America through 2021

Microbiome companies will benefit from the growing trend towards preventive health

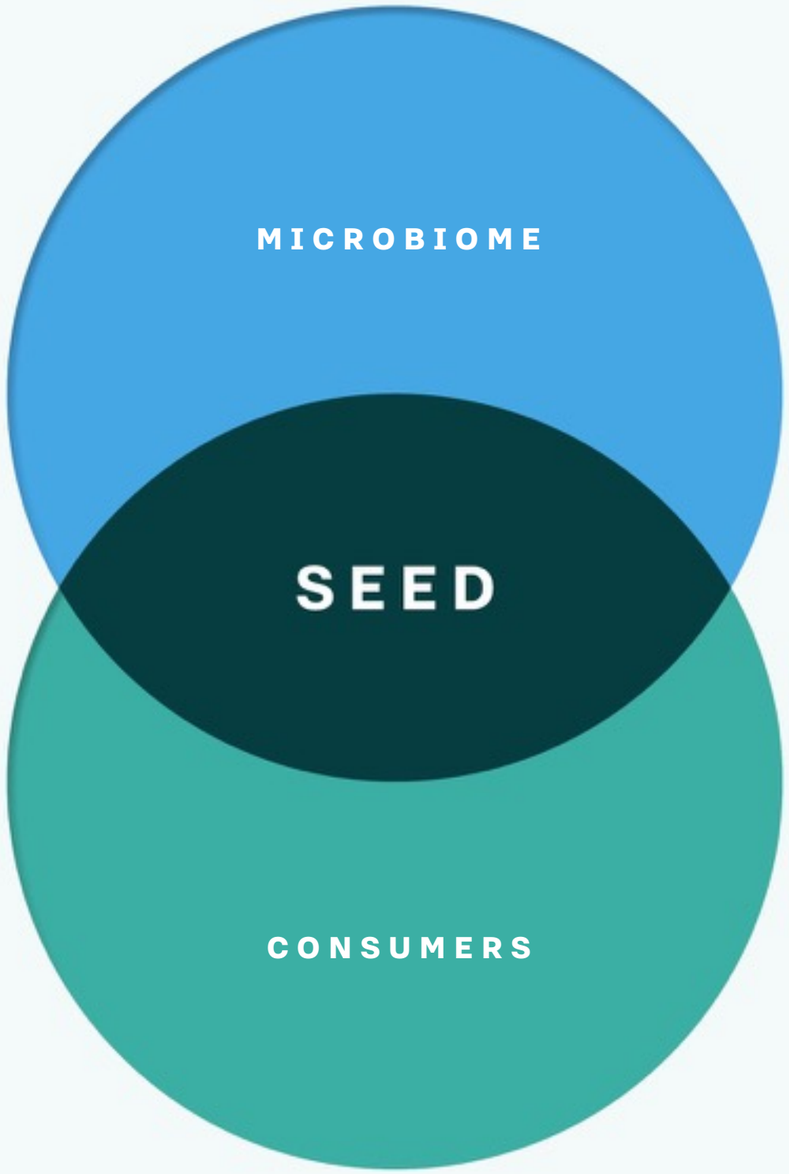


The microbiome landscape is attracting substantial investment but has no leader in consumer health



Until Seed - a microbiome company

We develop consumer health products with breakthrough research and new technologies



At the intersection of life sciences, technology, and CPG - founded by a serial entrepreneur and an industry expert

ARA KATZ
CO-FOUNDER

Entrepreneur - Marketer
Launched 6 DTC Influencer Brands and 1 Marketplace

Spring, Co-Founder + CMO

BeachMint, Founding Team

MindyBodyGreen, Investor

Advisor / consultant in tech, health, beauty, and fashion

Fellowships
MIT Media Lab - CCA (DesignMBA)

Speaking
Brands and marketing, influencers, digital commerce, entrepreneurship and now, consumer health and wellness

Proprietary network
Tech, design, CPG, fashion, entrepreneurs, wellness, and influencers

RAJA DHIR
CO-FOUNDER

Full-stack product developer - R&D, sourcing, extraction, manufacturing, testing, regulatory approval

Developed first plant-derived multivitamin and folate

Hold international patent for delivery system for microalgae-derived Omega-3

Proprietary supply chain and partner network spanning 19 countries. 5 continents and 6 institutions

Member
The Microbiome Coalition,
New York Academy of Sciences,
American Society for Microbiology,
and the Medical Nutrition Council of the American Society for Nutrition

Proprietary network
Academia, biotech, regulatory and manufacturing

With an interdisciplinary Advisory Board from biotech, medicine, academia, diagnostics, bioinformatics, CPG, retail and media

GENERAL ADVISORS

Ivy Ross,
Head of Design

Kristin Patrick,
Global CMO

Jim Fielding,
Global Head CPG/Retail

SCIENTIFIC + MEDICAL ADVISORS

Dr. Georg Gerber, MD, PhD, MPH

Dr. Paul Clayton, PhD

Dr. Geoffrey A. Preidis, MD, PhD

Dr. Robin Chadwick, JD, PhD

Dr. Anthony Sabatelli, PhD, JD

Dr. Jennifer Spinler, PhD

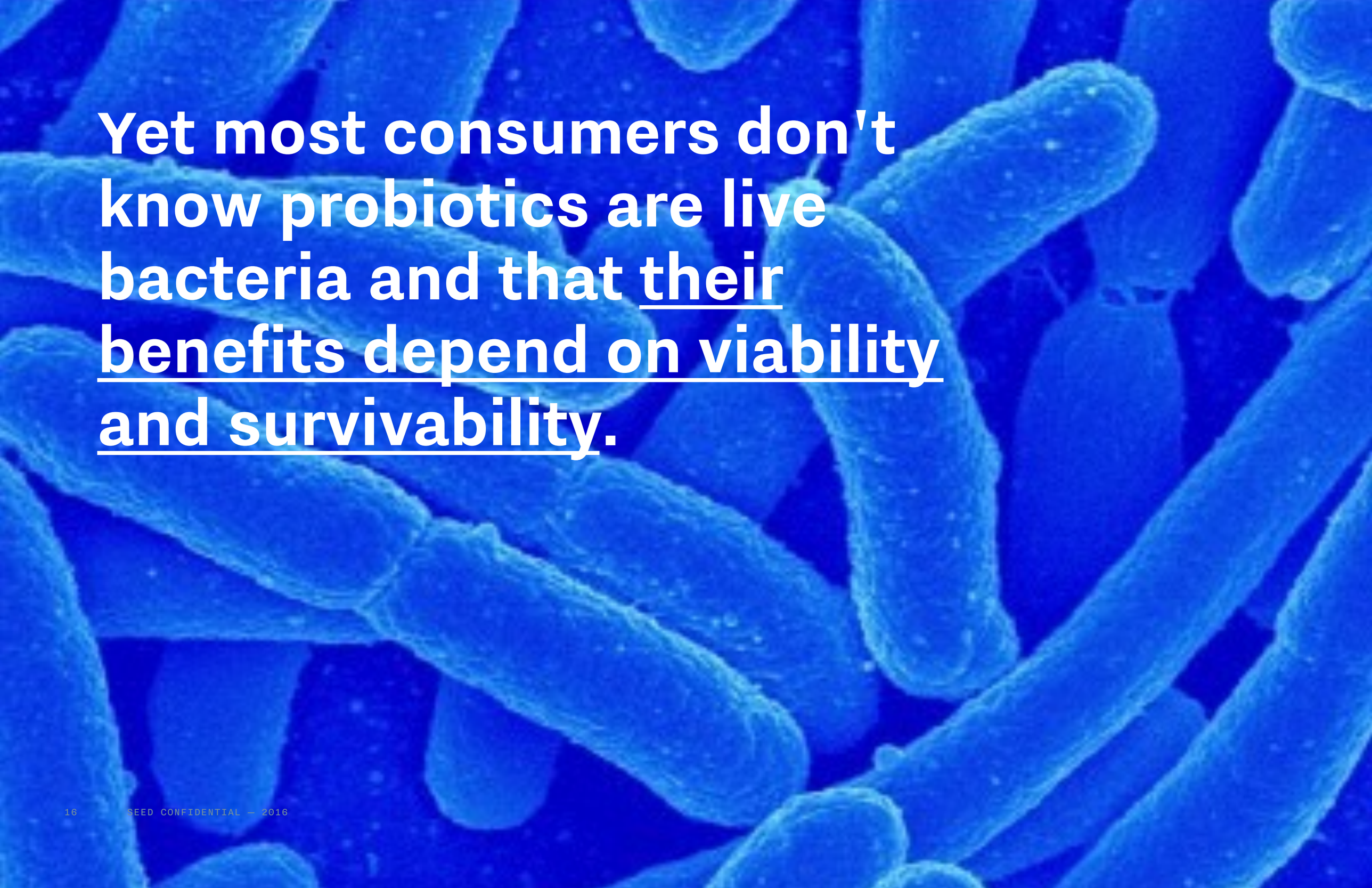
Dr. Gerard Honig, PhD

Our first product —
the next generation of probiotics

Probiotics are the fastest growing consumer health category in the world. Capsules and infant formula alone will reach $18.6B in sales by 2021.

Lux Research = Probiotic Infant Formula to Claim 76% Share of $22.9 Billion Market in 2024

Euromonitor@SupplySideWest, Probiotic Supplements Will Be the #1 Fastest-Growing Supplement in North America through 2021

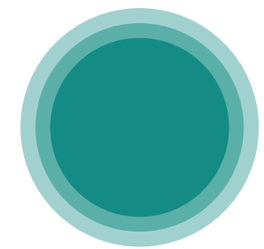


Yet most consumers don't know probiotics are live bacteria and that their benefits depend on viability and survivability.

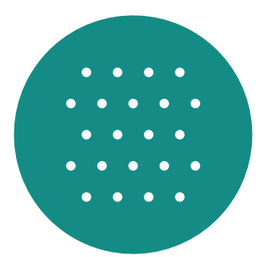
Specific strains have already been proven to -

'PROGRAM' INFANT IMMUNE SYSTEM FOR LIFETIME IMPACT

RESTORE THE MICROBIOME AFTER ANTIBIOTICS



MANUFACTURE VITAMINS, METABOLITES AND NEUROTRANSMITTERS



CONTROL THE GROWTH OF PATHOGENIC BACTERIA IN THE BODY

MEDIATE INFLAMMATION

But not all probiotics are created equal

		PROBIOTIC	YOGURT	KOMBUCHA
HUMAN PROBIOTIC STRAINS	✓	Some	✗	✗
PREBIOTICS	✓	Some	✗	✗
DELETION MICROBES	✓	✗	✗	✗
DELIVERY TECHNOLOGY	✓	Some	✗	✗
12 MONTH SHELF SURVIVABILITY	✓	Uncontrolled (some require refrigeration)	✗	✗
PROVEN SURVIVABILITY AT EACH DIGESTIVE STAGE	✓	✗	✗	✗
FREE OF BINDERS, EXCIPIENTS + AGENTS	✓	✗	N/A	N/A
GLOBAL REGULATORY ADHERENCE	✓	Some	N/A	N/A

It's not just about category leadership, it's about category creation

Keystone microbes with proprietary biopolymer delivery system - 1500x more viable

Viability verified at each stage of digestion by most controlled system across industry and academia

First product with deletion microbes

Novel prebiotics

Industry-leading manufacturing: Biofermenter temperature and pH optimized for human application

Highest global regulatory standards

By the bottle — unit economics

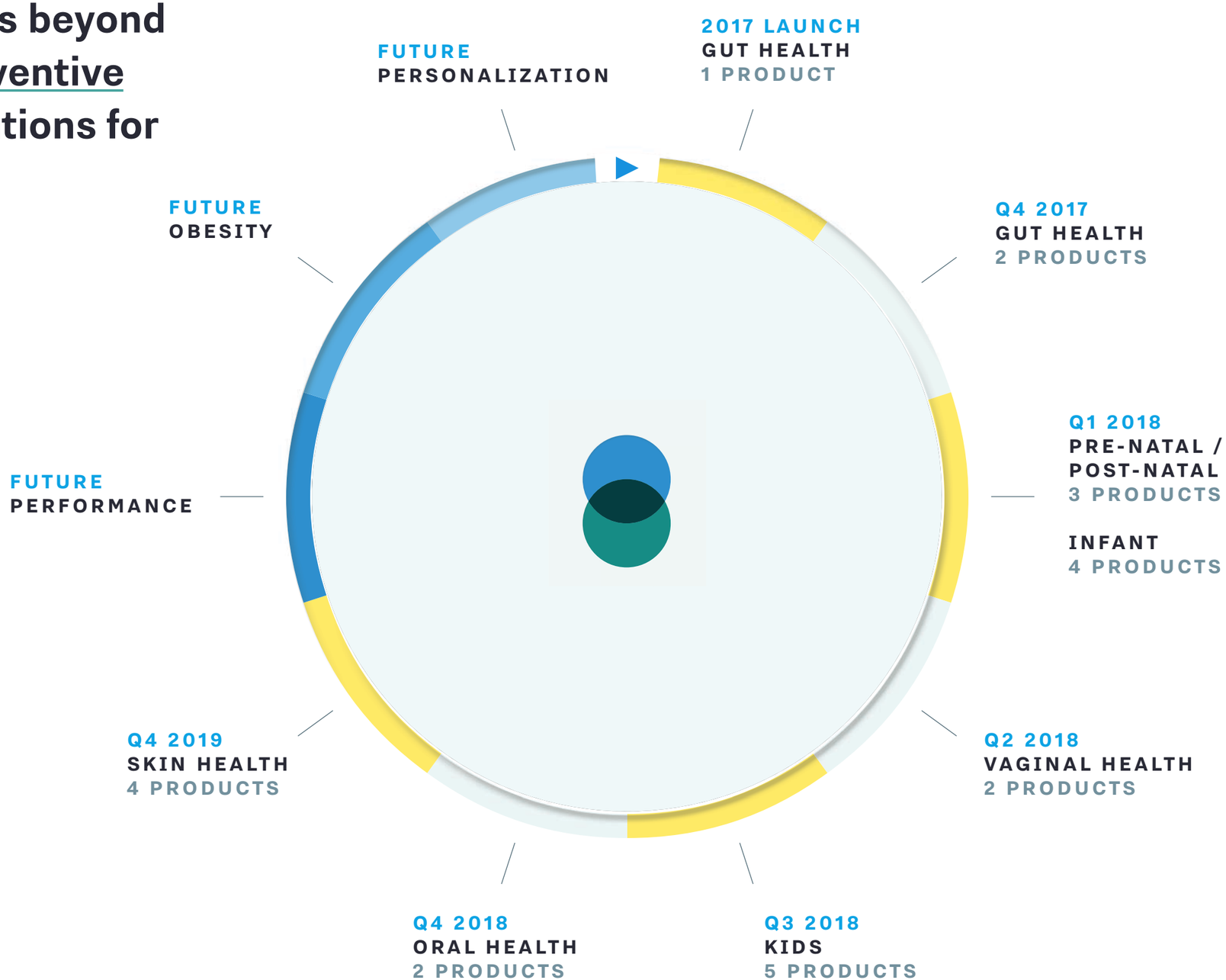
Costs:

	LAUNCH	+16 MONTHS	+24 MONTHS
PRODUCT 1	$14.83	$13.41	$12.07

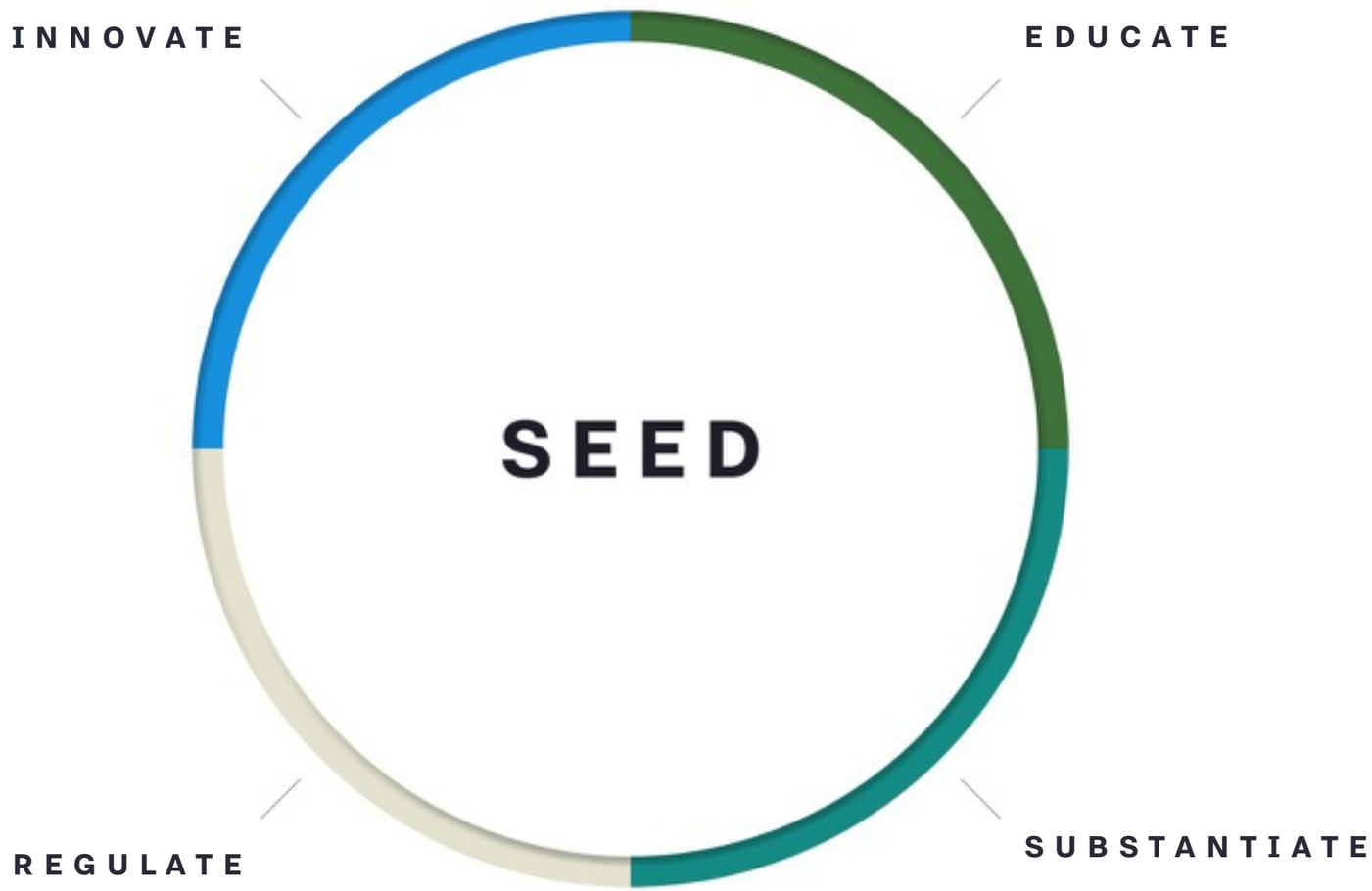
Margin by channel:

	LAUNCH	+16 MONTHS	+24 MONTHS
DTC	61%	67%	74%
DTP	19%	25%	32%
RETAIL	21%	26%	33%

Our product pipeline goes beyond the gut and includes preventive and need-based interventions for the whole body biome



Why we're uniquely positioned



We combine new technologies with findings from preclinical and clinical translational studies

Novel applications of breakthrough research

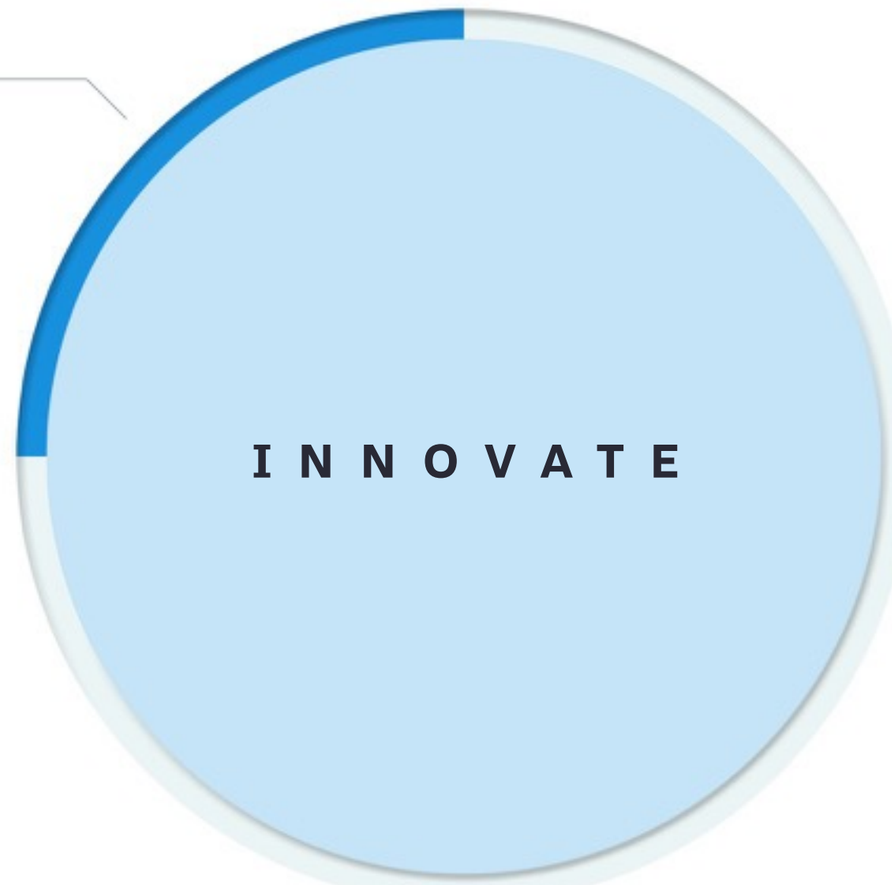
End-to-end discovery, development and manufacturing platform

19 country - 5 continent - 6 institution partner network

Stabilization processes and delivery systems for viability

Comprehensive IP strategy

AR packaging



Setting a new standard in testing

Highest viability standards for live organisms in academia and consumer health products

Hybrid model combining in vitro and ex vivo to remove confounding variables in human trials

Next generation sequencing technologies and bioinformatics tools

We regulate ourselves more than the FDA does -

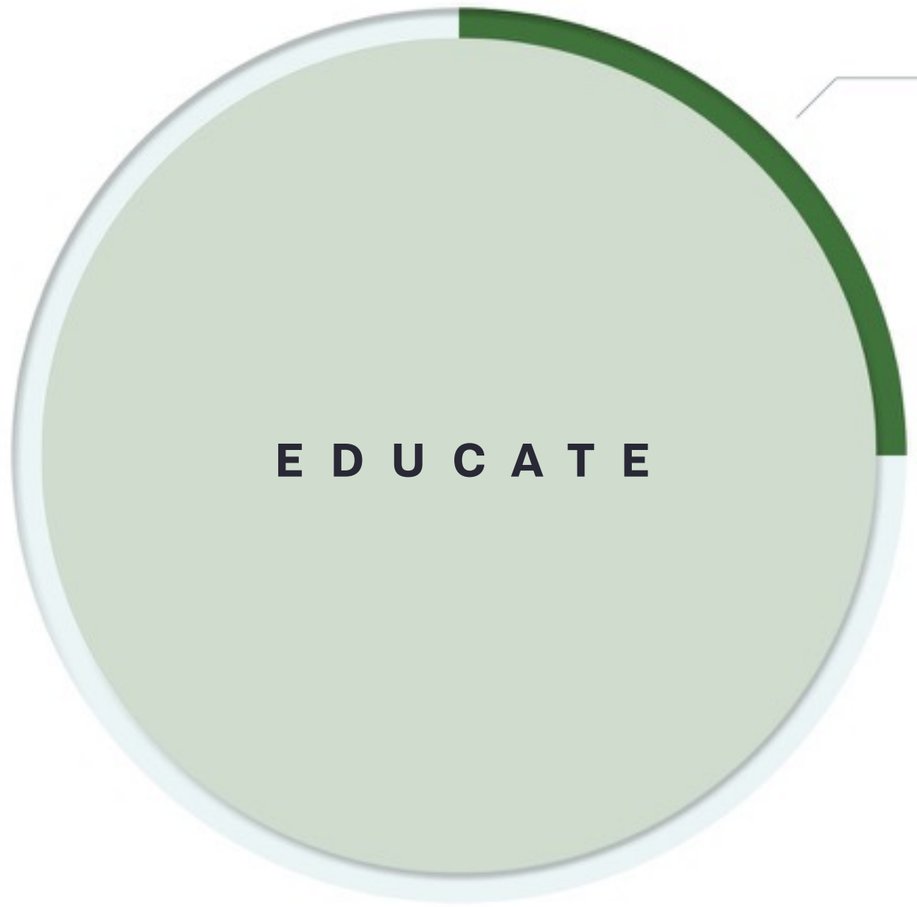
Poised to benefit from potential regulatory change

Raising manufacturing and testing standards beyond the most stringent international regulations

Substantiated for sale in EU, Scandinavia, Japan and Australia

Leading probiotic regulatory discussions with NIST (National Institute of Standards and Technology)

The antidote to trends, fear-driven marketing, pseudoscience and bad products



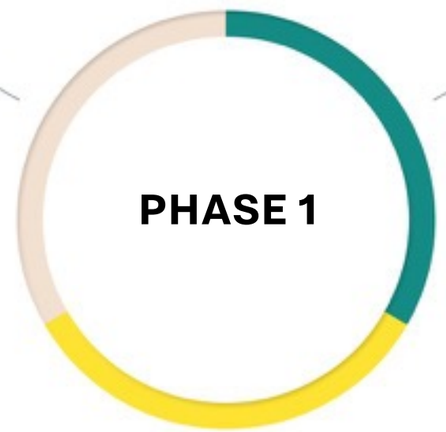
Mission driven premium content to make science accessible and to empower consumers

Thought leadership through counter-programming, truthful science, and anti-trend messaging

Syndication to extensive network of influencers, media, partners, and owned channels for acquisition and retention

A phased approach to market leadership…

SEED$_X$
Research + development
Substantiation + bioinformatics
Prototyping + discovery
Intellectual property



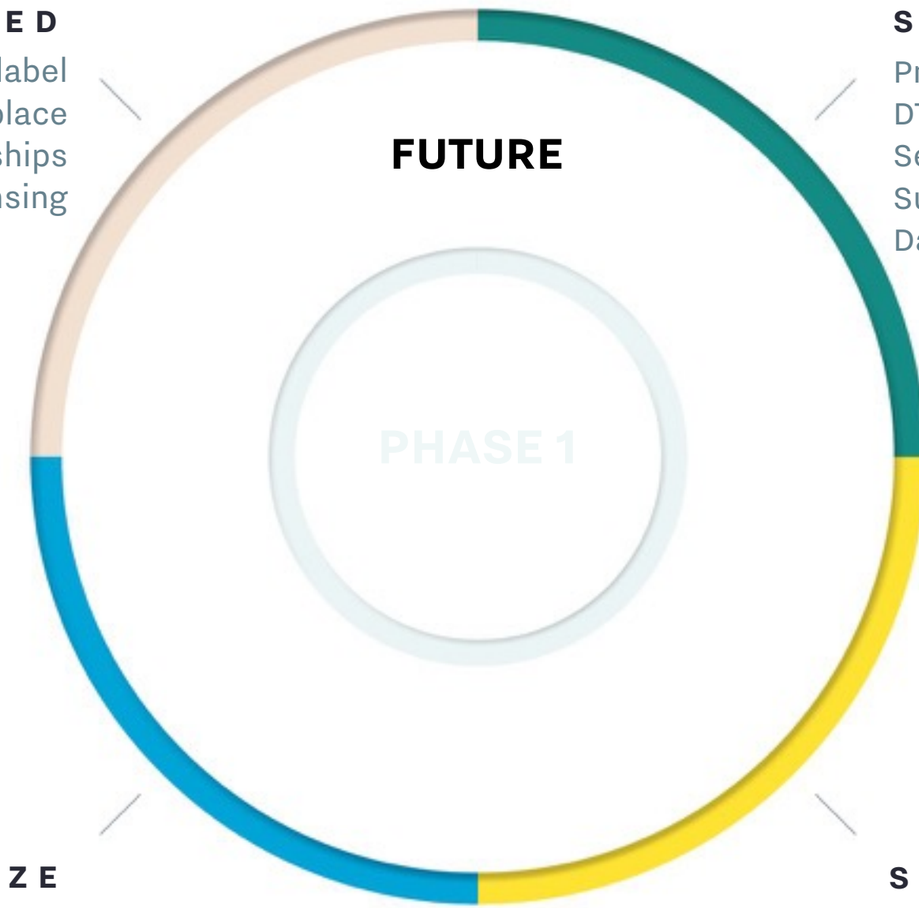
SEED
Direct-to-Consumer (DTC)
Targeted retail
Sub-brands

SEED R$_X$
Direct-to-Practitioner (DTP)

...and creators of what's next in microbiome consumer health

BY/SEED
Branded private label
Distributed commerce + marketplace
Partnerships
Licensing

SEED FUND
Provide capital + access to:
DTC + wholesale distribution
$Seed_x$ platform
Supply chain
Data



SEED PRIZE
Grant focused on breakthroughs in microbiome research

SEED GLOBAL
Focus on antibiotic resistance and food supply

Milestones to date

16 months of R+D

Filed first patent

Developed launch-ready proprietary pipeline of 16+ products

Built global supply chain and strategic partner network

Negotiated exclusivity rights to internationally patented delivery technology pre-revenue

Optimized product development and manufacturing process to scale

Selected advisors from 70+ scientists, doctors and leaders in academia

Opened national retail and DTP (Direct-to-Practitioner) partners

Recent consumer health acquisitions

Clorox acquires probiotic / digestive health company Renew Life for $290M in May 2016

P&G acquires New Chapter for >$400M, which was only active in the natural retail store distribution channel

Nestle acquires Pfizer's infant nutrition business

Pharmavite acquires FoodState

Pfizer acquires Alacer Corp (Emergen-C)

DSM acquires Ocean Nutrition for $530M

Schiff acquires Airborne for $150M

B2B: DuPont acquires Danisco for $6.3B

DSM acquires Martek for $1.1B

Reckitt Benckiser acquires Schiff for $1B in a bidding war

Seed is our journey towards understanding.

LAUNCHING 2017

Join us.

ARA KATZ
ara.ideas@gmail.com / 917.334.6142

RAJA DHIR
raja@theplantbasedcompany.com / 424.644.5464

APPENDIX

We're excited about our fast-growing strategic partner network that brings together academia, technology, retail and media in one brand

PARTNERS' AFFILIATIONS

HARVARD MEDICAL SCHOOL
מכון ויצמן למדע WEIZMANN INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE
BRIGHAM AND WOMEN'S HOSPITAL
UNIVERSITEIT GENT
THE ROCKEFELLER UNIVERSITY
KATHOLIEKE UNIVERSITEIT LEUVEN
MASSACHUSETTS GENERAL HOSPITAL
BCM
MIT
Nestlé
MERCK

TECHNOLOGY (NAMES REDACTED)

- PERSONALIZED MICROBIOME NUTRITION
- NEXT GENERATION DELIVERY SYSTEM
- DELETION TECHNOLOGY FOR PRECISION MICROBIOME TESTING
- HYBRID IN VITRO / EX VIVO DISCOVERY AND SUBSTANTIATION TESTING HARDWARE
- NEW COMPOUND DISCOVERY PLATFORM
- METAGENOMIC TESTING

STRATEGIC

pepsi
QUAKER

EDUCATIONAL CONTENT + PRODUCT PARTNERSHIP

THRIVE MARKET
SMARTY PANTS Health Simplified
SAKARA EAT CLEAN EAT WHOLE

EDUCATIONAL CONTENT + PRODUCT PARTNERSHIP

PARSLEY

PRACTITIONER PLATFORM DISTRIBUTION

natural partners

DIRECT TO PRACTITIONER REPRESENTATION OPTION

Presence

RETAIL REPRESENTATION OPTION

Scientific + Medical Advisory Board bios -

Dr. Georg Gerber, MD, PhD, MPH
Harvard Medical School (MD), MIT Division of Health Sciences and Technology (PhD). Co-Director, Mass. Host-Microbiome Center. Director of Computational Unit, Department of Pathology, Brigham and Women's Hospital. Co-Director, Center for Clinical and Translational Metagenomics. Professor of Pathology, Harvard Medical School.

Dr. Geoffrey A. Preidis, MD, PhD
Translational Biologist, Pediatrician, Gastroenterologist, and leader in global health and nutrition. Degrees from Harvard University and Baylor College of Medicine - Primary Investigator at Texas Children's Hospital. Served with Gates Foundation as expert reviewer in probiotics and global child health.

Dr. Anthony Sabatelli, PhD, JD
Over 20 years of industry experience in the biotechnology, pharmaceutical, chemical, material science, and consumer products industries. Designed, built, and managed an antibiotic discovery portfolio of several hundred patents - has done global patent work for Merck and Proctor & Gamble's Asia-Pacific expansion.

Dr. Paul Clayton, PhD
Fellow at the Institute of Food, Brain, and Behavior (Oxford). Fellow at The Royal Society of Medicine (London) and former Senior Scientific Advisor to the UK government's Committee on the Safety of Medicines.

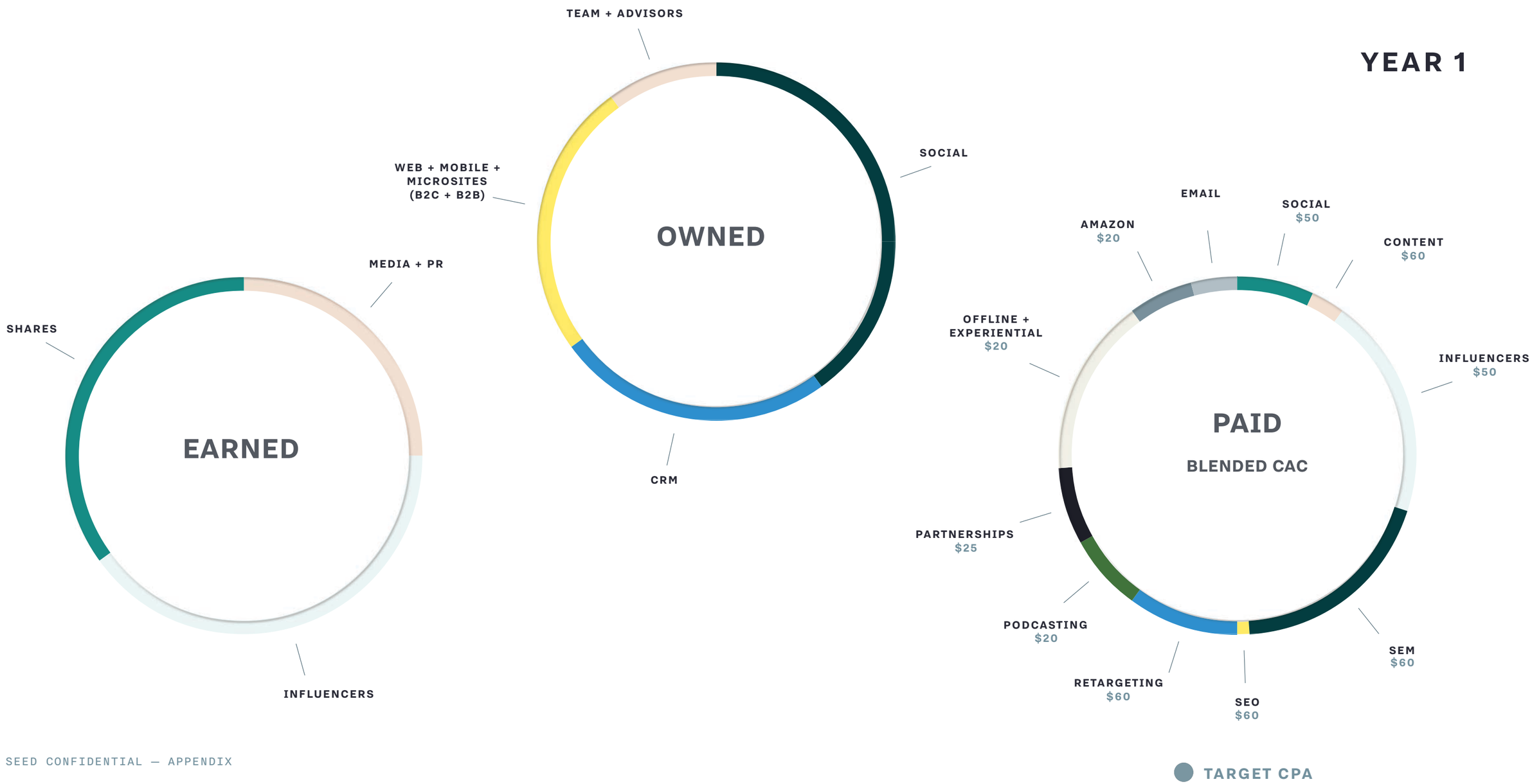
Dr. Robin Chadwick, JD, PhD
Molecular Biochemist (Yale), Postdoctoral Fellow (MIT), Principal and Board of Directors at the highest ranked Intellectual Property firm for patent prosecution, Schwegman, Lundberg & Woessner.

Dr. Jennifer Spinler, PhD
Molecular Microbiologist. Pathology and Immunology Instructor, Baylor College of Medicine. Microbial Genetics and Genomics Scientist at Texas Children's Microbiome Center. Pioneering functional genomics and developing novel phenotypic screens for probiotics and their secondary metabolites.

Dr. Gerard Honig, PhD
Improving human health through the commercialization of transformative technologies in life sciences. Founded Symbiotic Health to develop microbiome-based therapeutics to address critical public health challenges. Fellow at the Howard Hughes Medical Institute and trained in physiology, pathogenesis and immunology at UCSF, Rockefeller and NYU.

Holistic strategy to build a global community of engaged customers

YEAR 1



Leading the microbiome conversation through content

PREMIUM
Awe-inspiring journeys into our inner cosmos

Goal: Brand halo
Format: Long form

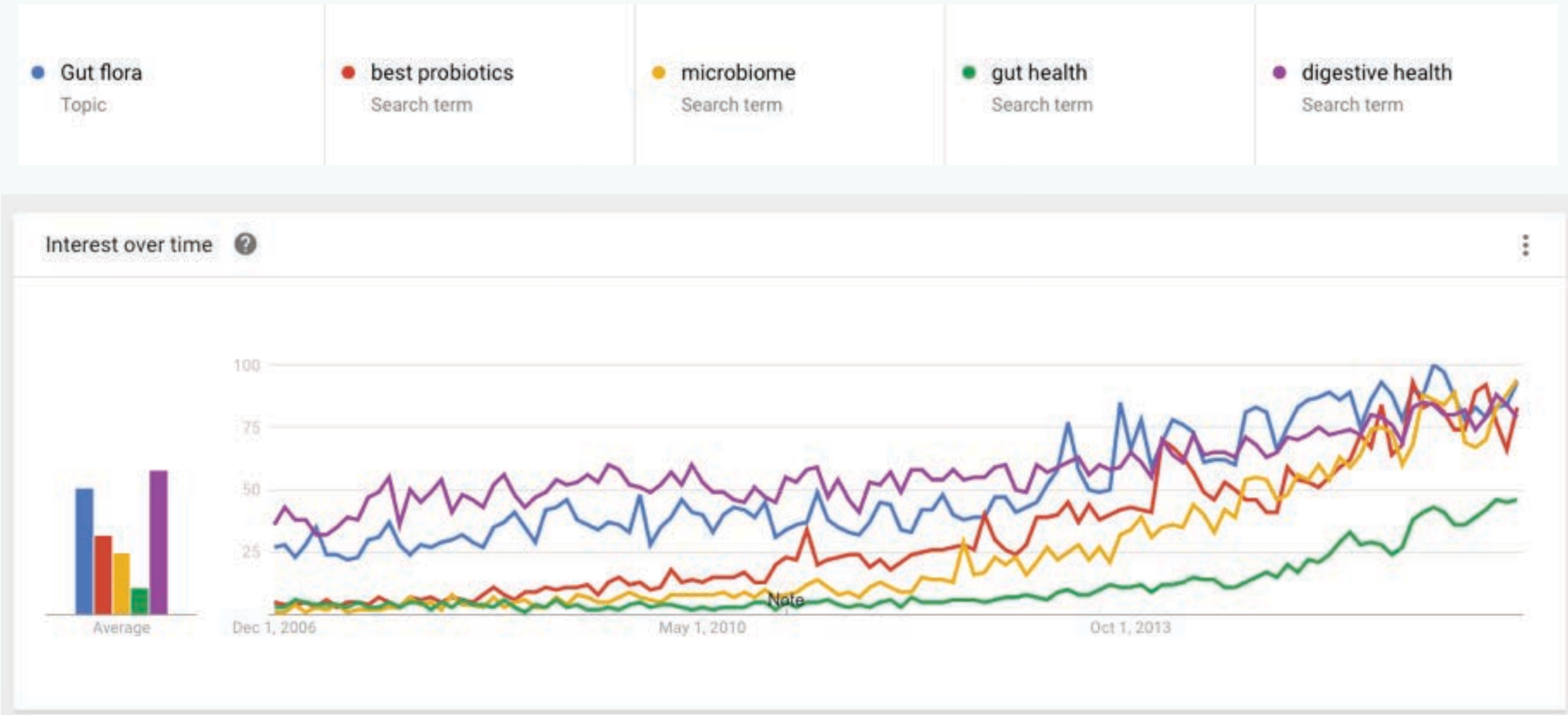
INVESTIGATIVE DOCUMENTARY
Mythbusting: Debunking health and wellness trends, pseudoscience and existing products

Goal: Authority / thought leadership
Format: Long, short and bite size

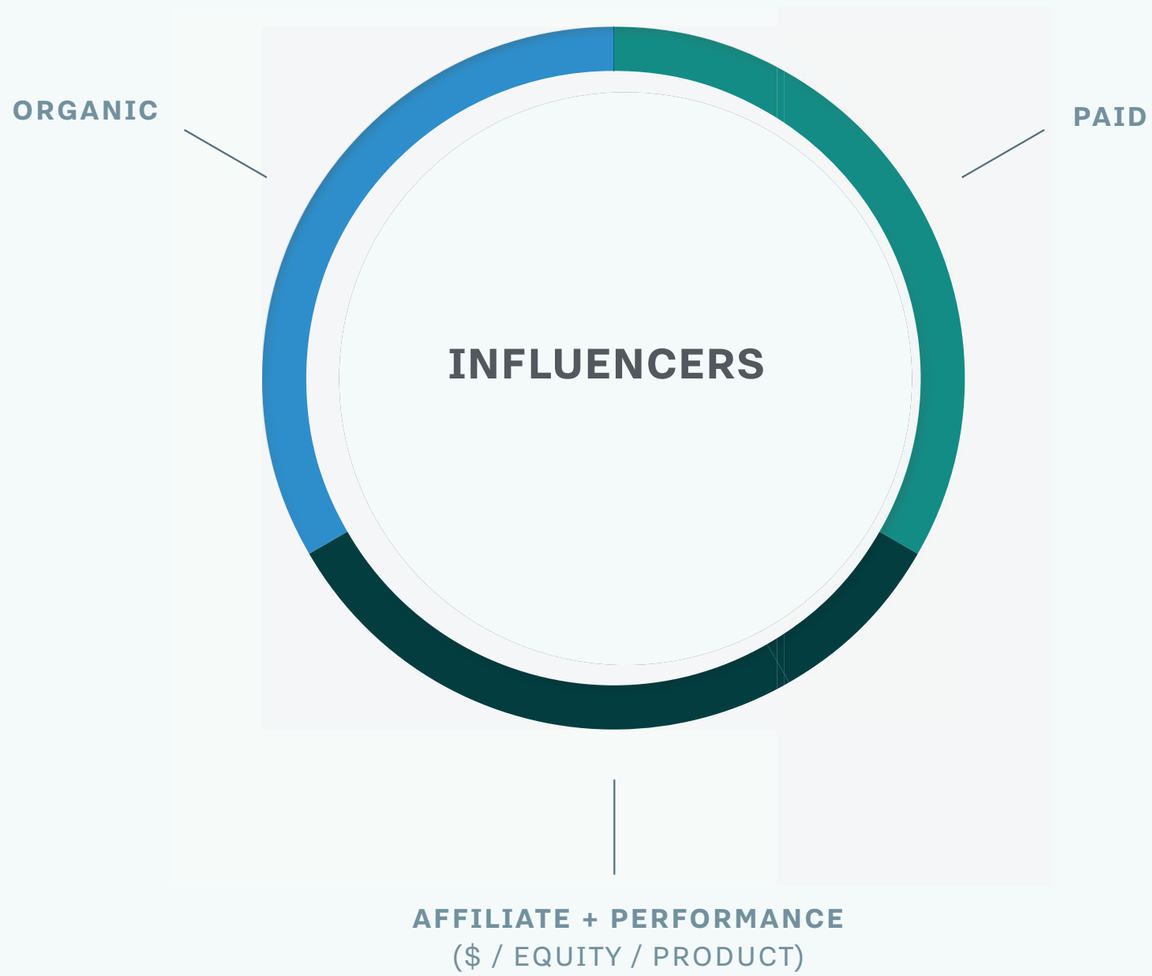
HOW TO'S
Empowering and educational to make biology accessible and entertaining

Goal: Customer acquisition
Format: Short and bite size
(mobile + social media optimized)

Tapping into a growing audience already searching for this content



Proprietary network of influence - from established leaders with proven conversion to niche experts with untapped communities



Building a global community of educated and empowered consumers

EXAMPLE MESSAGING

COUNTERPROGRAMMING
Think smaller.
Changing mindset to think about the unseen world inside us as the key to unlocking health.

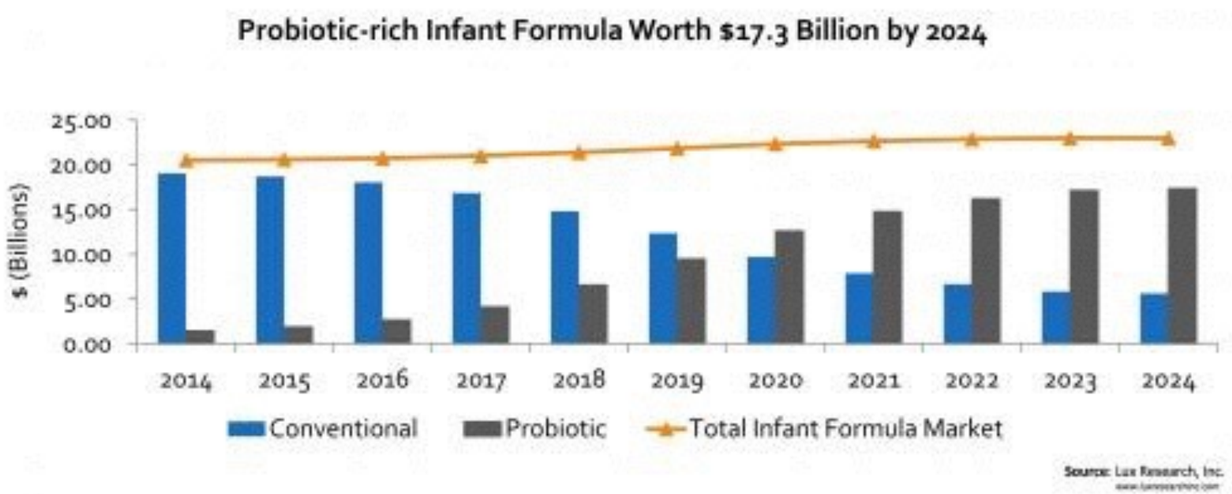
POSITIONING
There are no silver bullets.
Health is a way of life - it doesn't come in a bottle.
Authority through self-awareness and honesty.

ACCOUNTABILITY
We regulate ourselves more than the FDA does.
Trust as a result of accountability.

INSPIRATION
Everything is connected.
Science and biology as a source of awe and understanding.

EMPOWERMENT
You're smarter than that.
Intuition as currency to counter fear-based marketing.

Example of pipeline product market opportunity: probiotic infant formula



Probiotic Infant Formula to Claim 76% Share of $22.9 Billion Market in 2024

"Infant formula containing beneficial microbes will attain a market size of $17.3 billion, growing at a CAGR of 28% from $1.45 billion in 2014.

Probiotics are poised to storm the infant formula market, with probiotic-containing formula jumping nearly 11-fold in revenue to claim a whopping 76% share of the $22.9 billion market in 2024."

Lux Research

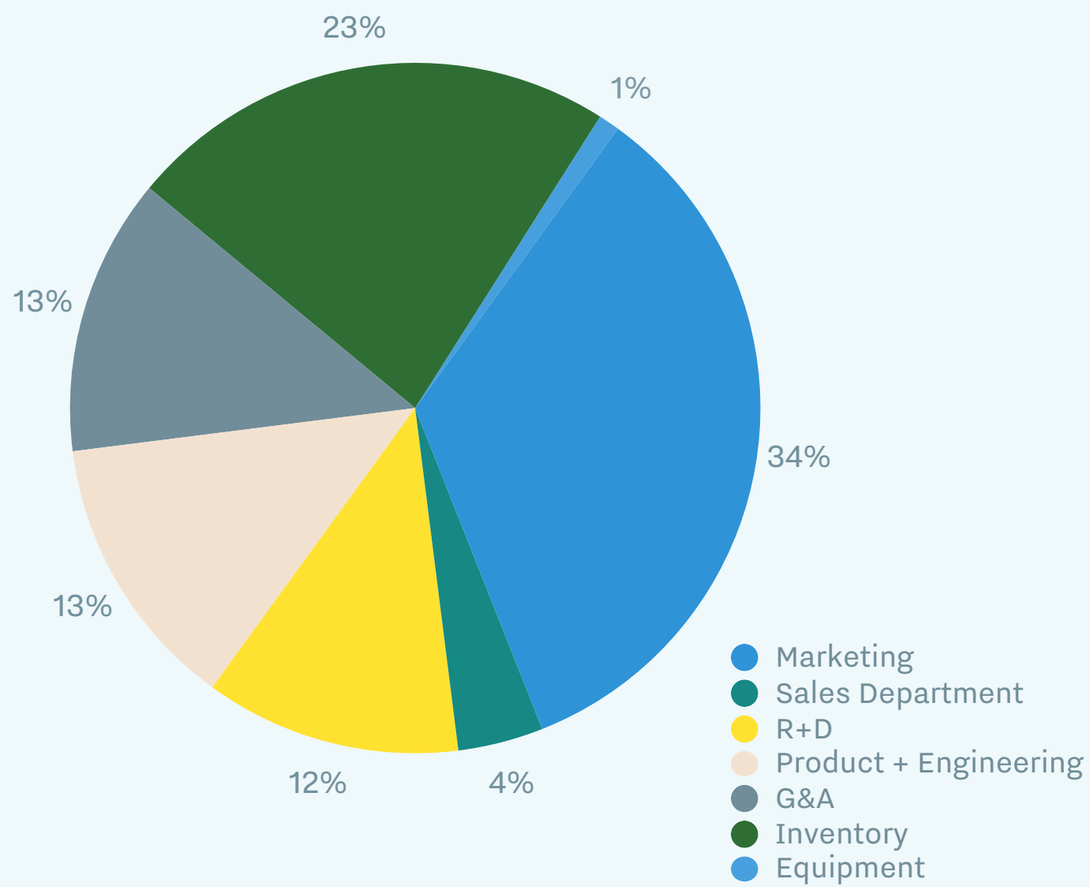
DTC customer acquisition -

YEAR ONE

9MOS	$225	$35	$32	7:1
CUSTOMER LIFETIME	CUSTOMER LIFETIME VALUE*	PAID CAC	BLENDED CPA	LTV: CAC

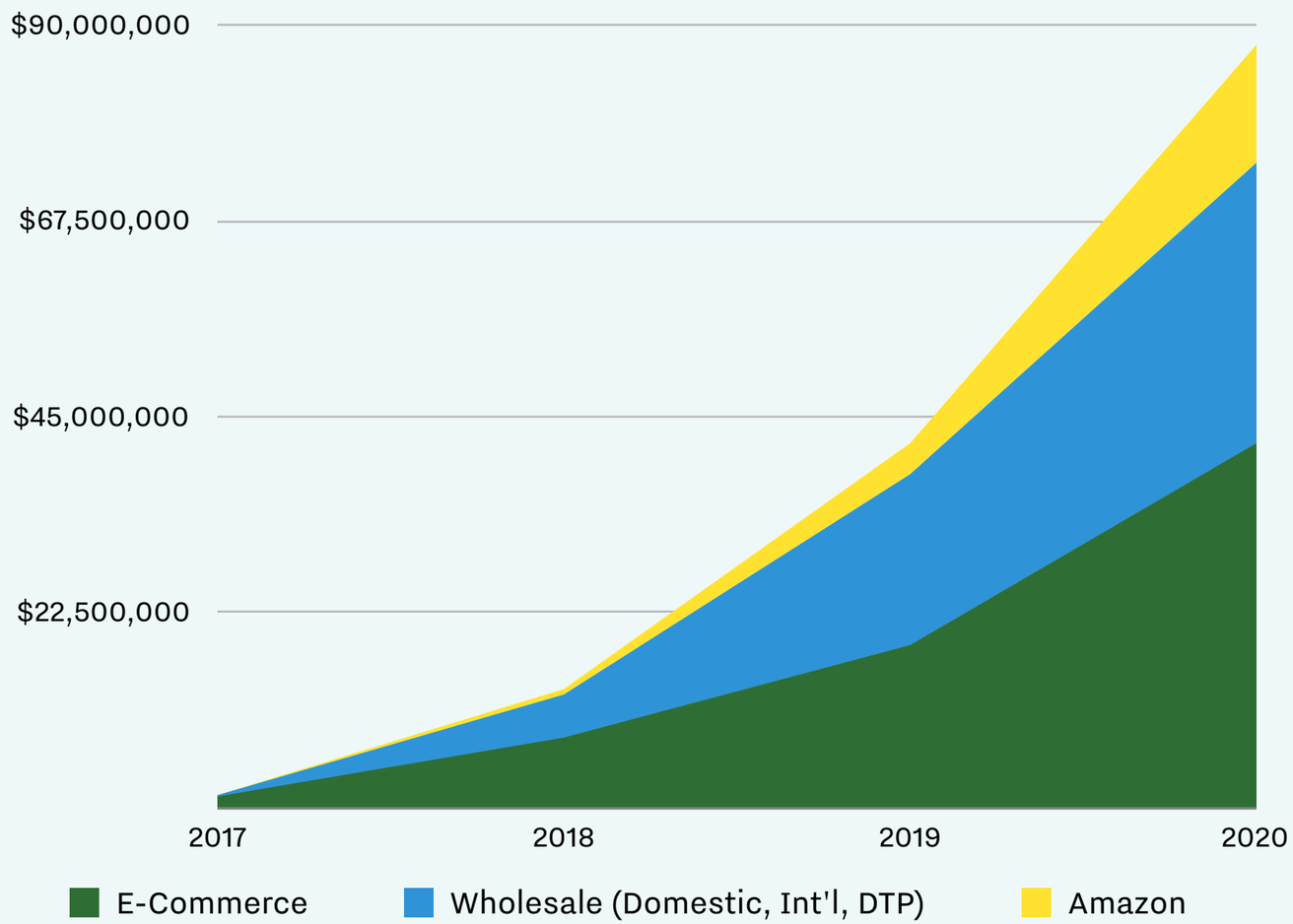
*Conservative estimate of 15% longtail retention

Use of funds



SEED		
Use of Funds		
Start Date	**Jan-17**	
End Date	**Dec-17**	
Investment	$ 6,000,000	
Sales Dept.	241,040	4%
Marketing	1,863,317	34%
Research and Development	642,900	12%
Product and Engineering	681,052	13%
G&A	705,140	13%
Inventory	1,270,549	23%
Furniture and Eq.	35,000	1%
OpEx	5,438,997	
Gross Profit	$ 720,917	
Cash Used	$ (4,718,080)	
Beg. Cash	$ -	
Cash Remaining	**$ 1,281,920**	
Note: Does not include balance sheet accounting		

Projections



	Forecast 2017	Forecast 2018	Forecast 2019	Forecast 2020
E-Commerce	1,310,712	8,082,205	18,714,144	41,946,704
Wholesale (Domestic, INTL, DTP	153,127	4,943,376	19,653,467	32,248,780
Amazon	-	631,494	3,565,454	13,581,934
Net Sales	**$ 1,463,840**	**$ 13,657,074**	**$ 41,933,065**	**$ 87,777,417**
E-Commerce %	*52%*	*55%*	*55%*	*59%*
Wholesale %	*21%*	*30%*	*32%*	*39%*
Amazon %	*0%*	*44%*	*44%*	*48%*

LTV	$ 225	$ 301	$ 245	$ 279
E-Commerce Margin	52%	55%	55%	59%
BCAC	$ 32	$ 23	$ 20	$ 20
Lifetime Margin	$ 118	$ 164	$ 133	$ 164
Post BCAC Margin	$ 86	$ 141	$ 113	$ 144
Net ROPI	**2.7**	**6.2**	**5.6**	**7.1**

Full model available upon request

LTV	$ 225	$ 301	$ 245	$ 279
E-Commerce Margin	52%	55%	55%	59%
BCAC	$ 32	$ 23	$ 20	$ 20
Lifetime Margin	$ 118	$ 164	$ 133	$ 164
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Net ROPI	**2.7**	**6.2**	**5.6**	**7.1**